

will definitely follow suit.

Technology changes every day and thus pushes the sector to grow and change with it. Operators will have more and more mVAS requirements and one can expect to see a huge requirement of professionals in this space.

Currently, there are over 100 mVAS companies in India and the number is growing steadily. Experts expect the industry to grow at least ten fold (from the current estimate of 15,000–20,000 mVAS professionals) in the next 3-5 years. Even if we take a conservative growth of five times, we find a requirement of about 75,000 to 100,000 professionals in the next few years.

As most of the telecom operators are based out Mumbai and NCR many organisations are coming up in these geographies. With telecom sector booming in India, this area is expected to see an unprecedented growth in terms of investment in research, development on one side and consumer spending and new business offering on other.

Types of careers

❑ **Content Developers / Owner** – These are jobs with companies such as Saregama and Mauj that seek specialists in developing copyrighted content. Typical roles available are of content executive, senior content manager and project manager depending on skill and qualifications.

❑ **Aggregator** – An aggregator is a company that would aggregate content such as games, wallpapers, ringtones and distribute it to suit customer needs and demands. Typical players here are Hungama Mobile and Indiatimes mobile. Most roles here would be of project managers and business development managers and requires individuals with a business mindset.

❑ **Software developer (Development Houses)** – Software houses developing cutting edge technology and applications such as payment gateways and games. Some players are mchek and Webaroo. Most roles here are of software developers, mobile game application developers/testers, BREW/iPhone/Android Application programmer, etc.

❑ **Technology Platform Developers/Enabler** – Provides the platform that plugs into the telecom company networks and acts as a bridge between aggregator and telecom companies. Some players include OnMobile and Cellnext. Some of the latest innovations include contextual mobile advertising and media streaming over handsets.

Some other roles that will require many qualified professionals are in mobile development, vendor management, enterprise solutions, key account management and product managers, deployment specialists, across operators and enterprises.

The career paths are typically standard. For example, a fresher would join as a Junior Developer then go on to become a Senior Developer, Technical Lead and then Manager.

The industry is flexible and open to fast learners. You could also be an entrepreneur as long as you have got the next killer application.

Why I chose this career?

Five years ago, I was working with internet ventures and I was smitten by the thought that “mobile phones will be the PC for India”. In USA, the PC is the lifeline for people. However, in India the highest penetration was by mobile phones. I am driven by the thought of what can be done with the power of a mobile phone looked at as an Internet-connected PC. I chose this career to create different applications for the Indian audience through their mobile device.

Face-2-Face with practitioner

“My role is all about making the consumer look at his mobile phone look like an internet-connected PC and help them maximise its benefits.”

Veer Chand Bothra
Founder, Revience